normative concept, such scopes were there. Most of such attempts were not prescriptions for an alternative development index but they were basically trying to show the incompleteness of the HDI, via intellectual satires. One such attempt was made by the economists and scholars of the London School of Economics in 1999 which concluded Bangladesh as the most developed country in the world with the USA, Norway, Sweden getting one of the lowest ranks in the index!

Basically, it is very much possible to come out with such an index. As for example, we may say that peace of mind is a necessary element of development and betterment in human life which depends heavily on the fact as to how much sleep we get everyday. Housetheft and burglary are major determinants of a good night sleep which in turn depends on the fact as how assured we go to sleep in our homes at night from burglars and thieves. It means we may try to know a good sleep by the data of thefts and burglaries in homes. Since minor housethefts and burglaries are under-reported in police stations, the surveyor, suppose tried to know such cases with data as how much 'locks' were sold in a country in a particular year! In this way a country where people hardly have anything to be stolen or no risk of being burgled might be considered having the best sleep in night, thus the best peace of mind and that is why this will be the most developed country!

Basically, the HDI could be considered as one possible way of measuring development which was evolved by the concerned group of experts with the maximum degree of consensus. But the index which calculates the development of economies on certain parameters might be overlooking many other important factors which affect the development of an economy and standard of living. As per experts, such other determinants affecting our living conditions might be:

(i) Cultural aspects of the economy,

(ii) Outlook towards the aesthetics and purity of the environment,

(iii) Aspects related to the rule and administration in the economy,

(iv) People's idea of happiness and prestige, and

(v) Ethical dimension of human life, etc.